

Could: Past Abilities

Could for past ability

Name: _____

Date: _____

Complete the sentences with could or couldn't.

- 1 When I was five, I _____ read. I was too young.
- 2 My grandfather _____ play the violin when he was young.
- 3 We _____ see the stars last night because of the clouds.
- 4 She _____ speak two languages at the age of ten.
- 5 I _____ swim when I was three, but now I swim well.
- 1 Could is the past form of can. **T / F**
- 2 I couldn't means I was not able to. **T / F**

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Fill in

1. couldn't
2. could
3. couldn't
4. could
5. couldn't

True or False

1. T
2. T

Teacher's notes

Contrast with can for present ability.